MHA ADVOCACY BRIEFING · SHORT VERSION

NOV 3 – NOV 4, 2026

What Michigan's new majority said about health care

The key points from election-night speeches and first interviews. Full quotes, themes and leader profiles are in the 20-page report.

9	79	28	12
speeches and press events analyzed	minutes of video transcribed	statements on health care	statements with direct hospital stakes

01

The bottom line

Health care was a central theme in election-night messaging but concentrated among few voices. Of **6** leaders on camera across **9** speeches and press events, only **3** addressed health care directly, producing **28** statements across **79** minutes of transcribed video. Senator-elect Abdul El-Sayed generated the vast majority, framing health care as unaffordable, corporate-dominated, and in need of structural overhaul. Rep. Debbie Dingell contributed statements emphasizing Medicaid anxiety among constituents and cost-of-living pressures. Governor-elect Jocelyn Benson offered brief pledges on affordable health care costs and women's health access. Separately, likely incoming Speaker Ranjeev Puri told the election-night watch party, per the Michigan Advance, that he 'watched healthcare be ripped away from our sick,' but he named no specific health policy that night.

The most actionable policy signals for hospitals center on Medicaid and federal spending. Both El-Sayed and Dingell identified reversing scheduled federal Medicaid cuts as an immediate priority; Dingell placed reversal among 'one of the first things' the new House majority would pursue, while El-Sayed warned that coverage losses would shift costs onto hospitals through increased emergency department use. El-Sayed predicted Republican crossover support for reversal, especially in rural communities. On coverage, Dingell committed to reinstating the ACA premium tax credit as an interim step, and El-Sayed warned of a premium cost spiral if coverage gaps widen. El-Sayed's repeated endorsement of Medicare for All and his criticism of Blue Cross Blue Shield's market dominance signal sustained scrutiny of insurer pricing and market structure. Notably absent from all appearances were hospital workforce shortages, detailed behavioral health policy, and any discussion of hospital finances or reimbursement.

02

Signals for hospitals

What MHA should watch for or prepare for, with one statement behind each.

01 Medicaid cuts reversal as early federal priority

Both Dingell and El-Sayed identified reversing scheduled federal Medicaid reductions as among the new majority's first acts, with El-Sayed warning that coverage losses would increase uncompensated emergency care at hospitals. MHA should prepare impact data on Michigan hospital coverage-loss scenarios and engage both offices as reversal legislation takes shape.

▶ 2:25 **Abdul El-Sayed:** *"So, the first most important thing we can do is the worst of this big ugly bill has not yet happened. They purposely pushed it into January of 2027, and that's the Medicaid cuts. We're …"*

02 Medicare for All advocacy from incoming Senator

El-Sayed made single-payer health care his signature issue and will enter the Senate as a vocal advocate for restructuring health care financing around a Medicare model. MHA should monitor for federal single-payer legislation or state-level 'Medicare for Michigan' proposals and assess potential effects on hospital revenue and reimbursement structures.

▶ 0:30 **Abdul El-Sayed:** *"Medicare for Michigan. We did it."*

03 Insurer market scrutiny and regulatory pressure

El-Sayed called for breaking up dominant insurers, capping rate increases, and banning stock buybacks, citing the attorney general's lawsuit against Blue Cross Blue Shield as evidence of monopoly power. MHA should watch for federal or state legislation targeting insurer consolidation and rate-setting, which could reshape payer dynamics and contract negotiations for hospitals.

▶ 5:18 **Abdul El-Sayed:** *"And these corporations are telling themselves, in particular, DTE and Blue Cross, right? Both of them functional monopolies, right? The attorney general right now is suing Blue Cross Blue …"*

04 ACA premium tax credit reinstatement timeline

Dingell committed to reinstating the ACA premium tax credit as an interim coverage measure, and El-Sayed warned of a cost spiral without subsidies in place. MHA should track the scope and timing of reinstatement legislation, as premium subsidies directly affect the size and stability of the insured population hospitals serve.

▶ 3:19 **Debbie Dingell:** *"reinstate the affordable care tax credit until we can figure out what we really need to do to fix a broken health care system."*

03

Who said what

Health statements per leader across the appearances reviewed.

LEADER	HEALTH STATEMENTS	TAKEAWAY
AS **Abdul El-Sayed** U.S. Senator-elect	**21** 9 high stakes	El-Sayed made health care the centerpiece of his victory messaging, advancing Medicare for All, warning of Medicaid cuts and insurer market dominance, and signaling sustained pressure on coverage, costs, and corporate practices in the Senate.

LEADER	HEALTH STATEMENTS	TAKEAWAY
DD **Debbie Dingell** U.S. Rep., MI-6	**5** 3 high stakes	Dingell centered Medicaid protection and affordability as immediate concerns, committing to reverse federal Medicaid cuts as among 'one of the first things' the new House majority would pursue and to reinstate the ACA premium tax credit.
JB **Jocelyn Benson** Governor-elect	**2**	Benson framed health care as one element of a broader affordability agenda and pledged to protect women's health access, but did not detail specific health policy proposals in her victory speech or transition press conference.
WB **Winnie Brinks** Lieutenant Governor-elect	–	Brinks did not address health care in her analyzed appearances, focusing her remarks on affordability broadly and collaborative governance.
CJ **Curtis Hertel Jr.** Michigan Democratic Party Chair	–	Hertel did not address health care, directing his remarks toward the party's electoral victories across the full ticket.
MM **Mallory McMorrow** State Senator	–	McMorrow did not address health care, focusing her remarks on economic concerns, grassroots organizing, and support for the Senate candidate.
RP **Ranjeev Puri** House Democratic Leader, likely Speaker	NEWS QUOTE	Puri was not captured on video, but per the Michigan Advance he decried health care being 'ripped away' at the election-night watch party. He named no specific health policy that night.
DC **Darrin Camilleri** State Senator	NEWS QUOTE	Camilleri was not captured on video, and his post-election statement, per The Detroit News, focused on the Senate Democratic majority's electoral success without addressing health care.

No post-election video found for: Eli Savit, Michigan Senate Democrats, Sean McCann, William Lawrence, Christina Hines, Jeremy Moss, Hillary Scholten, Kristen McDonald Rivet, Donavan McKinney, Rashida Tlaib, Gretchen Whitmer.

Prepared with AI assistance (Claude) for internal MHA use. Quotes are drawn from automated transcripts and machine-verified against the transcript text, but transcription errors are possible. Check the linked video before citing a quote externally.